Telangana Quietly Emerges as India's Model Gen-Z State

- Sama Ram Mohan Reddy



Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy, along with young footballers of Hyderabad, poses for a photograph after playing a friendly match opposite Lionel Messi, in Rajiv Gandhi International Cricket Stadium, Hyderabad, on December 13, 2025.

In July 2026, India's youth once again demonstrated their immense potential, with Hyderabad at the centre-stage. Telangana-based Skyroot Aerospace successfully launched India's first private orbital class rocket, Vikram-1. The average age of the team behind Vikram-1 is just 28 years — Peak Gen-Z.

There is much more to the story of India's youth than conventional pathways to education and employment. The rise of Gen-Z represents a broader aspiration for skills, innovation, entrepreneurship and meaningful career opportunities. At its core, the focus is on creating the right ecosystem for skill development, employability and fulfilling the aspirations of young Indians.

In India, competitive examinations remain one of the most popular means to secure coveted college seats and public-sector jobs. At the same time, the changing nature of the economy is opening up exciting new avenues for young people across sectors. Skilling and creating corporate jobs are the way to go for fulfilling aspirations of the youth. Something that Telangana, the country's youngest state, is championing for not just the youth of the state but from across India.

Every year, in pursuit of careers, young students and professionals move to Hyderabad like no other Indian city. It consistently records highest net positive talent migration in India, driven by strong job growth, lower living and operating costs, and most importantly, the unmatched standard of living.

Telangana under Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy is quietly pioneering a transformative model that addresses three aspects: bridging the skills gap, creating high-quality jobs, and building an ecosystem where aspiration meets opportunity. These benefit Gen-Z the most, and all Indian cities should try and replicate the same.

India's rapidly expanding economy is creating enormous opportunities for young talent. As industries evolve, aligning education and skills with emerging opportunities is becoming increasingly important. Telangana, on the other side, is championing proactive solutions through world-class skilling initiatives and investment-friendly policies that are generating lakhs of jobs, particularly in the booming Global Capability Centres (GCC) sector.

Since Revanth Reddy assumed charge, Hyderabad has emerged as India's GCC powerhouse. The city has captured approximately 46% of new GCC establishments in India, attracting over 197 centres since the Congress party assumed power in December 2023. This translates into lakhs of high value jobs in IT, BFSI, aerospace, pharma, and more, positioning Telangana as a magnet for global talent and innovation.

The Young India Skills University (YISU) is a unique public-private partnership initiative that redefines higher education by placing industry leaders at the helm. The university's name is self-explanatory, and draws inspiration from Mahatma Gandhi's pre independence journal Young India.

With complete operational independence granted to partners like Mahindra and Apollo Hospitals, YISU offers tailored, cutting-edge training programs aligned with real-world skill demands. Already, hundreds of trainees have secured high-profile placements, including opportunities linked to major investments like the Microsoft Data Centre. This model ensures that education is not theoretical but a direct conduit to employment.

Under the YISU umbrella, the transformation of Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) into Advanced Technology Centres (ATCs) is delivering remarkable results. Sixty-five ATCs are now operational across Telangana, providing Industry 4.0 skills in robotics, CNC machining, electric vehicles, digital manufacturing, and advanced simulation — in partnership with Tata Technologies.

Over 1,000 students have already been placed across these centres, with more than 10,000 jobs facilitated for the first graduating batch of the 2024-2026 cohort in the coming months. A monthly scholarship of ₹2,000 per student, backed by ₹82 crore in government commitment, makes it a complete package for aspiring youth.

One standout success story exemplifies the inclusive impact: the Government ITI and ATC in the remote tribal town of Utnoor in the state. In a historic campus placement drive, 99 out of 100 students — mostly from local tribal communities — secured placements in multinational giants like Schneider Electric, Tata Motors, and Foxconn's Apple iPhone division in Bengaluru.

Parents, once worried about limited prospects in a far-flung area, are now overjoyed as their children step into stable, well-paying careers. This shows how targeted skilling can uplift rural and tribal youth.

By September 2027, 54 more ATCs would become operational. Revanth Reddy's government is also overhauling the entire Polytechnic college system, integrating it progressively under the YISU framework to create a seamless ecosystem from vocational training to advanced employability.

Initiatives like TOMCOM (Telangana Overseas Manpower Company) have already facilitated overseas jobs for 14,000 candidates, with 4,500 currently enrolled, opening doors to talent-deficit markets in Germany, Japan, South Korea, and beyond.

The Telangana model demonstrates what proactive governance could offer to Gen-Z. By prioritizing skill training, global partnerships, and job creation, the state is creating a strong foundation for the aspirations of young Indians — through tangible outcomes and new opportunities. As India advances towards its development goals, Telangana offers a replicable blueprint: invest in human capital, empower industry collaboration, and deliver jobs.

Under the Young India Skills University (YISU) program, Telangana is producing model Gen-Zs aka 'Young Indians' - in true spirit.

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